

PRACTICE TOOL

THE RE-PATTERNING WALK SESSION PLANNER

Structured Walking Practice to Build New Movement Habits

CHASE THE DATA, NOT THE SENSATION.

The Movement Re-patterning Toolkit | Dr. Jonathan Schutza, PT, DPT

30-Minute Session Structure

Follow this format for each practice session

Phase 1: Warm-Up

5 minutes

Easy walking at comfortable pace to establish rhythm and prepare body.

Relax shoulders

Land softly

Breathe naturally

Phase 2: Focus Block 1 — Heel-to-Toe Roll-Through

10 minutes

Focus on smooth transition from heel strike through toe-off.

Feel heel contact

Roll through arch

Push off big toe

Phase 3: Focus Block 2 — Cadence & Stride

10 minutes

Work on step rate and preventing overstriding.

Shorter, quicker steps

Avoid overstriding

Upright posture

Phase 4: Cool-Down

5 minutes

Easy walking to integrate learning and return to natural rhythm.

Walk naturally

Notice changes

Mental review

4-Week Progression

Gradually increase difficulty and integration

Week 1: Foundation

Establish baseline, practice cues, get comfortable with structure

3x/week

Week 2: Awareness

3-4x/week

Increase body awareness, refine technique, add variation

Week 3: Extension

4x/week

Extend duration, add terrain variety, challenge balance

Week 4: Integration

Daily

Integrate patterns into daily walking, maintain awareness

Tips for Success

- ✓ Start on flat, familiar terrain
- ✓ Wear shoes that allow good ground feel
- ✓ Focus on ONE cue at a time
- ✓ Stop if pain increases >2 points
- ✓ Record observations after each session

Session Log

Track your practice sessions

Date	Duration	Focus Cue	Pain (0-10)	Notes

Weekly Check-In

Review progress at the end of each week

Week 1 Check-In

What cue felt most natural? What was most challenging?

Week 2 Check-In

Have you noticed any changes in daily walking? Any pain changes?

Week 3 Check-In

Are you able to maintain cues for longer periods? What's improving?

Week 4 Check-In

How integrated do the new patterns feel? Next steps?